In Washington, the US State Department called the cancelation of the separation law a provocation that hampers de-escalation efforts.

The organization of reserve officers that initiated the march to Jerusalem and other demonstrations has warned that if the overhaul is confirmed by the Knesset, thousands will refuse to answer call-ups. In a message to Gallant they said: “The army for which you are responsible is going to pieces in front of your eyes.”

The Likud minister of the economy, Barkat, declared that were the Supreme Court to oppose Rotman’s compromise, he would obey the court’s decision. Unusual and interesting. In the Likud, people say that Barkat did not declare this on his own. Did Netanyahu find the ladder that would allow him to climb down from the tree? Does it mean that Levin and Rotman will have to be replaced? Could it lead to a rebellion of the hardliners of the Likud? Fascinating and, possibly, promising.

## *Wednesday, March 22*

After an American rebuke, Netanyahu insisted that the cancelation of the separation law was the cancelation of a humiliating law, but added that settlers would not return to the five vacated sites. How will Smotrich react?

A *Haaretz* article uncovered fake information disseminated by the IDF during the 2021 Guardian of the Walls operation in Gaza, directed at Israeli citizens. This is a shameful attempt to mobilize one’s own public opinion for a bombing and destruction campaign. It was possibly a first—but who knows?—and, from what we can tell, it didn’t influence anybody. What else shall we discover in the coming months and years?

At the outset of this Knesset session, Moshe Gafni of Torah Judaism introduced a law threatening jail terms for Christian missionary activity among Jews in Israel. Christians saw this as persecution. Netanyahu reassured them today: no measures will be taken against Christian activity.